

Study: Millions of Europeans Could Die from Heat by 2100

A new study warns that millions of Europeans could die from heat-related causes by the end of the century.

The study was based on computer simulations of predicted climate activity in 854 different European cities. It found that extreme temperatures, mostly heat, could kill as many as 2.3 million people in Europe by 2100.

The researchers said the number of predicted deaths could be reduced if nations are able to find better ways of cutting carbon pollution levels and dealing with extreme heat.

Currently, cold weather kills far more people in Europe than hot weather. But the study found that as temperatures continue to rise, deaths from cold weather will lessen over time. However, heat-related deaths are predicted to rise sharply.

Scientists at the London School of Hygiene and Tropical Medicine led the research. The results appeared recently in a study in the publication *Nature Medicine*.

The researchers urged increased efforts to reduce greenhouse gases and expand indoor air-cooling systems and cooling centers in parts of Europe. Without such efforts, places in Italy, southern Spain and Greece are likely to see large increases in heat deaths related to climate change, the study found.

On the other hand, much of Scandinavia and Britain are predicted to see fewer temperature-related deaths, largely because low temperatures are expected to become more moderate.

Pierre Masselot studies the environmental effects of human health at the London School of Hygiene and Tropical Medicine. He helped lead the research.

Masselot told the Associated Press that drops in cold deaths in northern parts of Europe are happening in areas not as populated as places further south. "The Mediterranean is a so-called climate hotspot," he said. "It's a region that is warming much quicker than the rest of the world. And Malta is right in the middle of it."

The study predicts Malta's temperature-related deaths will increase by 269 people for every 100,000 individuals by the end of the century. On the other hand, Ireland's rate is expected to drop slightly to 15 per 100,000 people.

European officials reported several heat waves have killed thousands of people in recent years across the continent. The highest number was in 2003, when about 70,000 deaths were recorded.

Among the areas predicted to see the most deaths from future temperature rises is Barcelona, Spain. The study found almost 250,000 people could die from temperature-related causes in that city by 2100. And the study warned that Rome and Naples could have up to 150,000 deaths.

The study predicted that more than 5.8 million extra heat deaths would be linked to climate change. At the same time, the study found cold-related deaths would drop by 3.5 million.

I'm Bryan Lynn.

The Associated Press reported on this story. Bryan Lynn adapted the report for VOA Learning English.

Vocabulary

simulate - v. จำลอง (ทำหรือสร้างบางสิ่งให้มีลักษณะหรือทำงานคล้ายของจริงแต่ไม่ใช่ของจริง)

region - n. ภูมิภาค (พื้นที่เฉพาะในประเทศหรือทั่วโลก)

Reading Comprehension Quiz

1. What is the main warning issued by the new study mentioned in the article?

- A) Europe will experience a significant drop in cold-related deaths.
- B) Millions of Europeans could die from heat-related causes by the end of the century.
- C) Climate change will primarily impact northern European countries.
- D) Carbon pollution levels are projected to decrease sharply.

2. On what basis was the study conducted?

- A) Extensive interviews with climate experts across Europe.
- B) Analysis of historical weather patterns over several centuries.
- C) Computer simulations of predicted climate activity in 854 European cities.
- D) Direct observation of temperature changes in Mediterranean regions.

3. Approximately how many people in Europe are predicted to die from extreme temperatures, primarily heat, by the year 2100 according to the study?

- A) 854,000
- B) 1.5 million
- C) 2.3 million
- D) 70,000

4. According to researchers, how can the number of predicted heat-related deaths be reduced?

- A) By migrating populations from southern to northern Europe.
- B) By focusing solely on improving cold weather infrastructure.
- C) By cutting carbon pollution and finding better ways to deal with extreme heat.
- D) By expanding the number of European cities included in the study.

5. What is the current leading cause of weather-related deaths in Europe, as stated in the article?

- A) Hot weather
- B) Cold weather
- C) Flooding
- D) Storms

6. What is the predicted long-term trend for heat-related deaths in Europe as temperatures continue to rise?

- A) They will lessen over time.
- B) They are predicted to rise sharply.
- C) They will remain constant.
- D) They will only affect a small percentage of the population.

7. Which institution led the research discussed in the article?

- A) The Associated Press
- B) Nature Medicine
- C) The London School of Hygiene and Tropical Medicine
- D) A consortium of European universities

8. Where were the results of this study published?

- A) VOA Learning English
- B) The Associated Press
- C) The London Journal of Health
- D) Nature Medicine

9. Besides reducing greenhouse gases, what other measures did researchers urge to combat rising heat deaths?

- A) Promoting outdoor activities in summer.
- B) Expanding indoor air-cooling systems and cooling centers.

- C) Encouraging migration from southern to northern Europe.
- D) Developing new weather prediction models.

10. Without increased efforts to reduce greenhouse gases and expand cooling systems, which specific areas are likely to see large increases in heat deaths?

- A) Scandinavia and Britain
- B) Ireland and Malta
- C) Italy, southern Spain, and Greece
- D) Northern parts of Europe

11. Why are Scandinavia and Britain predicted to see fewer temperature-related deaths?

- A) They already have extensive air-cooling systems.
- B) Their populations are declining significantly.
- C) Low temperatures are expected to become more moderate.
- D) They are not affected by global warming.

12. What was Pierre Masselot's role in the research?

- A) He was the primary author of the Nature Medicine publication.
- B) He translated the study findings for VOA Learning English.
- C) He helped lead the research on the environmental effects of human health.
- D) He provided computer simulations for the study.

13. According to Pierre Masselot, why is the Mediterranean described as a 'climate hotspot'?

- A) It has a very high population density.
- B) It is experiencing a decline in cold-related deaths.
- C) It is warming much quicker than the rest of the world.
- D) It is an area with many cooling centers.

14. By how many people per 100,000 individuals is Malta's temperature-related deaths predicted to increase by the end of the century?

- A) 15
- B) 70,000
- C) 269
- D) 3.5 million

15. When was the highest number of heat-wave related deaths recorded in Europe in recent years, according to European officials?

- A) By the end of the century
- B) In 2100
- C) In 2003
- D) During several recent years